Chumpha Phanit

Resource Identifier: CULT-FEST-002

English Translation: Festival of the Granary

Category: Festival | Subcategory: Agricultural

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Women & Community (Traditional Observation (Horam 1977, Hodson 1911))

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Seasonal Timing / Occasion: December (Post-harvest thanksgiving)

Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Post-harvest thanksgiving festival celebrated in December. Specially honors women as custodians of the grain; involves ceremonial transfer of granary responsibility and blessings for food security.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Chumpha phanitli lumkaza kashung, kacham kashiman malailaka."

"Shanao mibingna chumkhur kakhon, chumpam kachivali ningyanganung."

"Varewui kashukli ringpha mazaida, shim kachivali tara kashung."

English Translation & Meaning:

"At the Chumpha festival, the bounty of harvest is gathered, and scarcity is banished from our midst."

"The women of the household unlock the sacred granary, receiving honor as guardians of life and grain."

"Rejoicing in divine blessing, every family enjoys abundant cups of fellowship and peace."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Formal cleansing and sanctification of the family granary (Chum) by female household heads.
2. Ritual opening of the granary door and invocation of blessing upon the stored paddy.
3. Preparation of first rice delicacies from the newly harvested crop.
4. Household visits and gift-sharing honoring maternal uncles and married daughters.
5. Community prayers of thanksgiving for food security through the winter months.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Women household heads (Custodians of Granary), Family Lineages, Village Community

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